

Freedom of Information Act Appeal
Control Number: COW2026000731

To the USCIS FOIA/PA Appeals Office:

I hereby appeal USCIS's determination dated May 12, 2026, stating that "no records relating to your request were located."

The agency's response is not credible on its face because publicly available federal procurement records demonstrate that USCIS awarded multiple contracts specifically referencing the "Vetting of Wedding-Based Schemes (VOWS)" platform identified in my request.

Specifically:

On October 28, 2025, USCIS awarded Task Order 70SBUR26F00000003 to Palantir Technologies in the amount of approximately \$100,000. The award description states:

"THE PURPOSE OF THIS TASK ORDER IS TO IMPLEMENT PHASE 0 OF THE VETTING OF WEDDING-BASED SCHEMES (VOWS) PLATFORM."

The awarding agency and sub-agency are identified as DHS and USCIS.

On December 10, 2025, USCIS awarded Task Order 70SBUR26F000000026 to Palantir Technologies in the amount of approximately \$99,500. The award description states:

"THIS FOLLOW-ON PHASE 1 VOWS TASK ORDER IS DESIGNED TO SUPPORT USCIS IN ACHIEVING ITS OBJECTIVE OF IMPLEMENTING THE VETTING OF WEDDING-BASED SCHEMES (VOWS) PLATFORM."

On February 13, 2026, USCIS awarded Task Order 70SBUR26F000000055 to Palantir Technologies in the amount of approximately \$99,500. The award description states:

"THIS FOLLOW-ON PHASE 2 VOWS TASK ORDER IS DESIGNED TO SUPPORT USCIS IN ACHIEVING ITS OBJECTIVE OF IMPLEMENTING THE VETTING OF WEDDING-BASED SCHEMES (VOWS) PLATFORM."

These procurement records establish that USCIS not only possesses records concerning VOWS, but that the agency entered into multiple implementation-related task orders spanning at least several months.

My original request sought records sufficient to describe the nature, purpose, and operational use of the VOWS platform, including system descriptions, concept-of-operations materials, privacy assessments, and policy guidance. Given the existence of multiple implementation task orders, it is highly unlikely that no responsive records exist anywhere within USCIS systems.

At minimum, responsive records would reasonably be expected to exist in:

- acquisition and contracting files;

- statements of work or performance work statements;
- task order supporting documentation;
- emails coordinating implementation;
- privacy or compliance reviews;
- operational briefings;
- pilot program documentation; and/or
- records maintained by the USCIS offices sponsoring or administering the VOWS effort.

Accordingly, USCIS's response suggests either:

1. the search conducted was inadequate;
2. the request was construed too narrowly; or
3. relevant program offices were not searched.

I therefore request that USCIS:

- conduct a new and reasonably calculated search for responsive records;
- search all offices reasonably likely to maintain records related to the VOWS platform and the referenced Palantir task orders;
- search using the terms "VOWS," "Vetting of Wedding-Based Schemes," and the above-referenced task order numbers; and
- release all reasonably segregable non-exempt material.

I also request that USCIS describe with greater specificity the scope of the original search conducted, including which offices, custodians, systems, and search terms were used.

Thank you for your reconsideration of this matter.

Sincerely,

Michael Wriston